Kraków's long-running annual Jewish festival, in heartwarming local initiatives, often at a grassroots level, and in other ways. Meanwhile, thousands of Poles of Jewish origin, many of whom were not raised in a Jewish milieu, have begun to explore their Jewish past in a way that would have been unthinkable until the late 1980s. The newly opened Polin Museum stands as a bold monument to the triumphs and tragedies of a people who once constituted 10% of the country's population. Jews had truly been a "nation within a nation" who dwelled alongside Poles, "together but apart."

This Jewish reawakening has been accompanied by prodigious scholarship on virtually every aspect of the millennial Jewish experience in Poland. The destruction of Polish Jewry, including the role of elements of the autochthonous Polish population, whether as enablers or accessories, has become an especially compelling subject for stalwart Polish researchers.

Though ostensibly on the wane, antisemitism in contemporary Poland has certainly not disappeared and has actually demonstrated remarkable vitality, especially given the dramatic changes in Polish society. According to "The ADL Global 100: An Index of Anti-Semitism," released in the first half of 2014, 14,000,000 Poles—some 45 percent of Poland's adult population—hold antisemitic views, higher than in Hungary, Romania, or the Czech Republic (which stands lowest at 13 percent).[5] There are troubling methodological questions about this survey, but its shortcomings notwithstanding, these findings have been validated in more authoritative research.

Many long-term observers of events in Poland—and especially people involved in the revival of Jewish life in the country—have expressed dismay, frustration and even disbelief at these findings, especially as so much has changed in Poland since the collapse of Communism. A 2013 nationwide study, conducted by the Center for Research on Prejudice at Warsaw University, found that 63% believe in the idea of a Jewish conspiracy, roughly the same number as in 2009, when 65% of respondents affirmed their belief in this idea. Some 23% were found to hold traditional, religious-based beliefs about Jews, including the idea of Jews as Christ-killers who use Christian blood for ritual purposes.[6] According to this survey, the provinces of Lublin and Łódź are the most antisemitic regions. These areas, once home to large Jewish communities, have been hard hit economically by the sweeping transformations of the last twenty-five years. Many localities suffer widespread unemployment and lag far behind the more economically successful areas. Not surprisingly, the inhabitants of small provincial towns and villages are more likely to harbor antisemitic attitudes—or to express them—than city dwellers.

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